



Individual Instructor Report Fall 2024 Version B for STA 235H - DATA SCI FOR BUSN APPS: HON (05210) (Henrique Bolfarine)

Project Title: **Course Evaluations Fall 2024**

Courses Audience: **43**

Responses Received: **42**

Response Ratio: **97.7%**

Report Comments

Guide to the Interpretation of Course Evaluations at UT Austin

The goal of course evaluation process at UT Austin is to drive teaching excellence and to support continuous improvement in teaching and learning experiences. The two sets of scales used for core evaluation questions and the associated weights are:

Strongly Agree (5)
Agree (4)
Neutral (3)
Disagree (2)
Strongly Disagree (1)

Excellent (5)
Very Good (4)
Satisfactory (3)
Unsatisfactory (2)
Very Unsatisfactory (1)

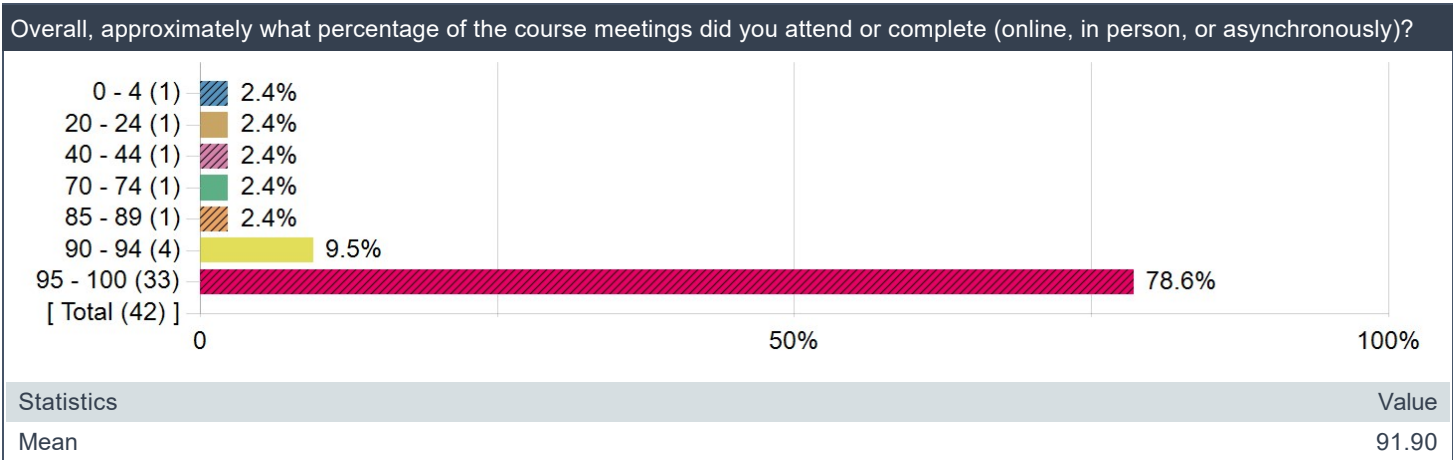
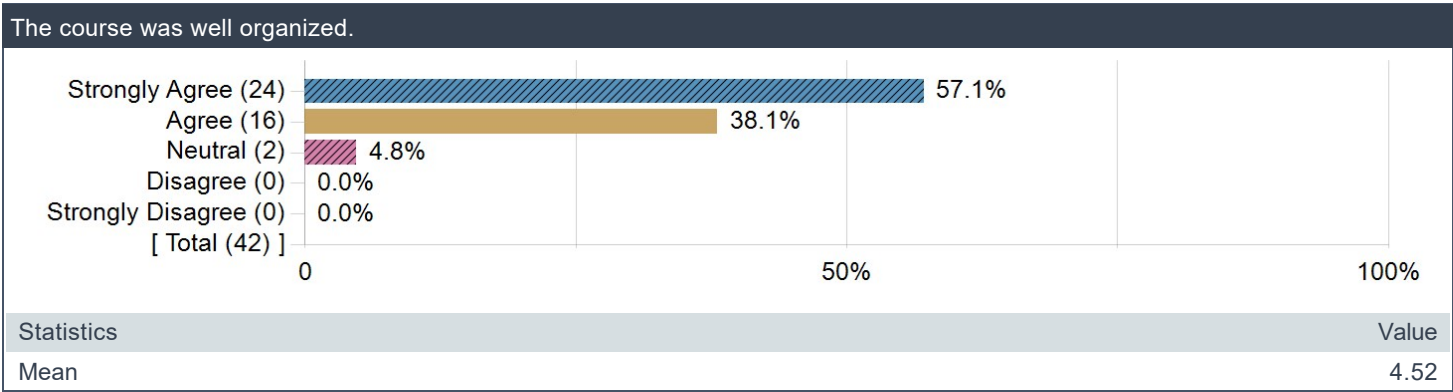
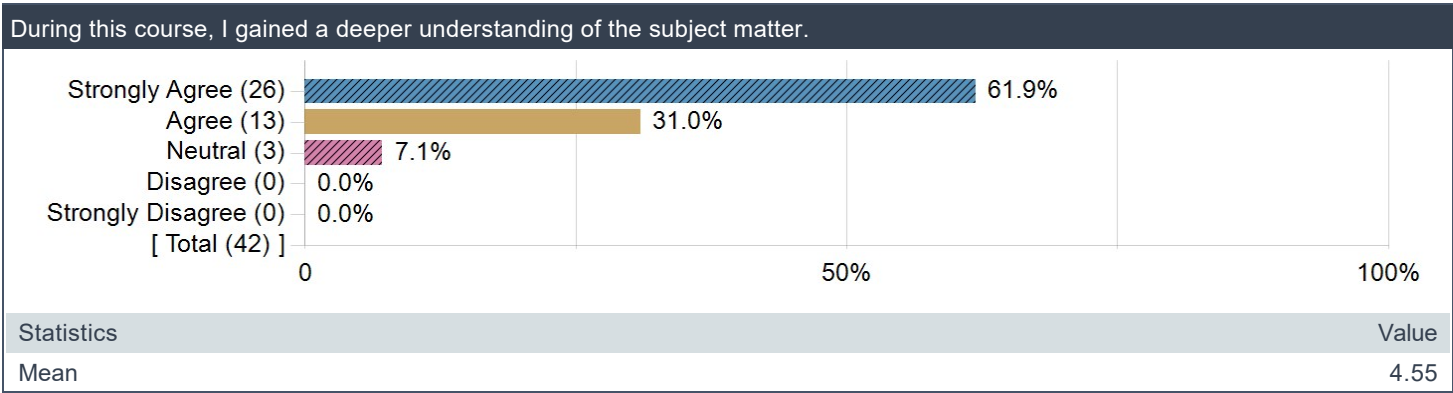
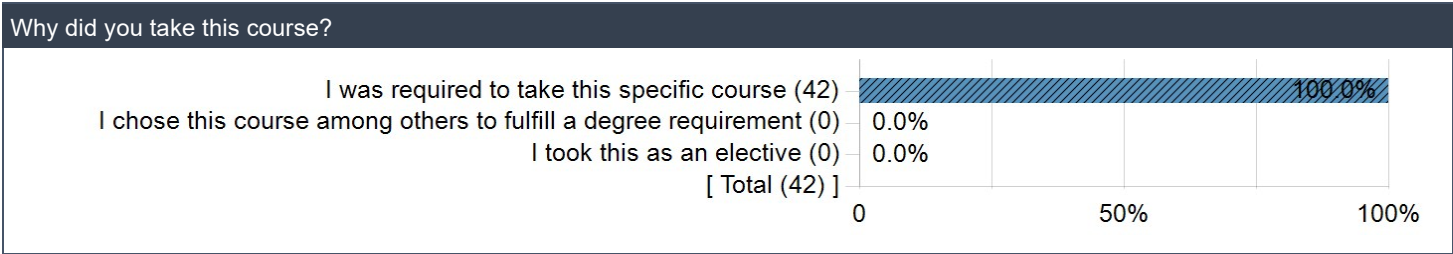
The Mean is calculated by adding all of the weights for a single question and dividing by the number of respondents. The course workload question is not averaged.

The number of students (e.g. respondents) marking each option is reported for each of the items. These frequency distributions provide information about the level of student ratings and the spread and shape of the class distribution of responses. The distributions thus provide a picture of student perception of a course.

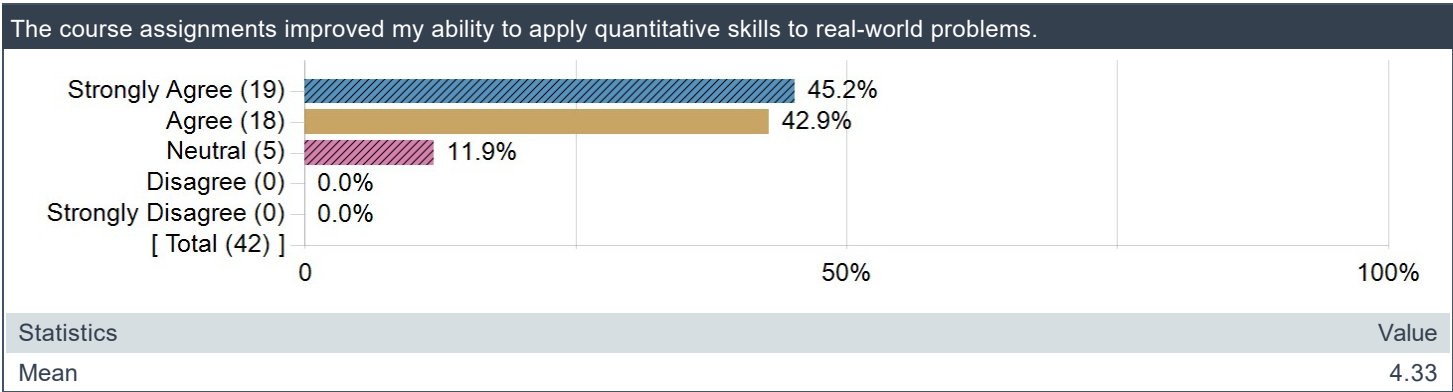
Course evaluations provide snapshots of student perspectives on their course-level learning experiences. Most experts on teaching evaluation advise that no individual method gives the complete picture of an instructor's teaching effectiveness; multiple and diverse measures, on multiple occasions, are advised to give a full picture of the teaching effectiveness of a particular instructor. Moreover, other factors, such as size of class, level of the class, and content of the course, can cause small variations in the ratings. Therefore, student perspectives for a particular instructor or course should be interpreted as a snapshot, and not as providing complete information on the teaching effectiveness of that instructor.

Creation Date: **Thursday, January 23, 2025**

Course Questions



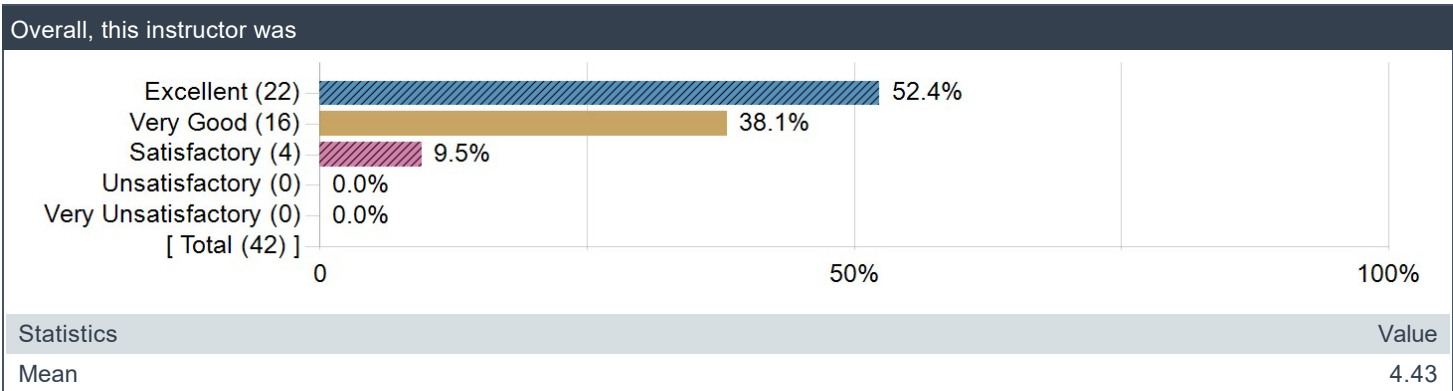
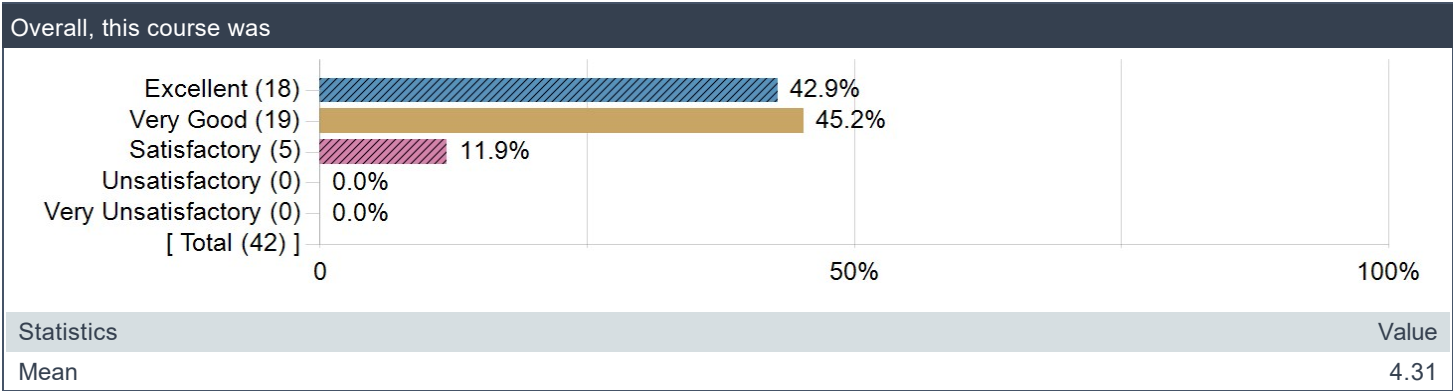
The course assignments improved my ability to apply quantitative skills to real-world problems. (Flag Question)



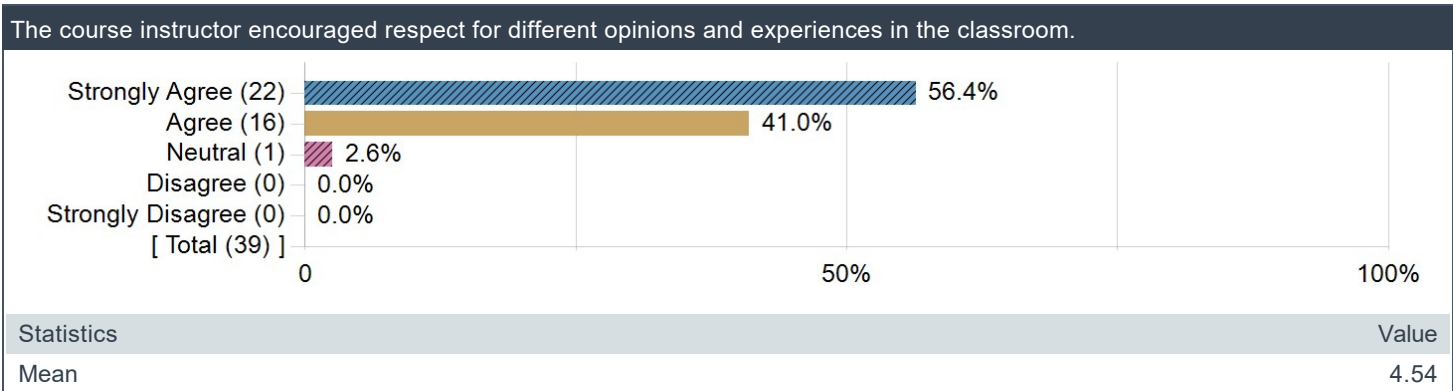
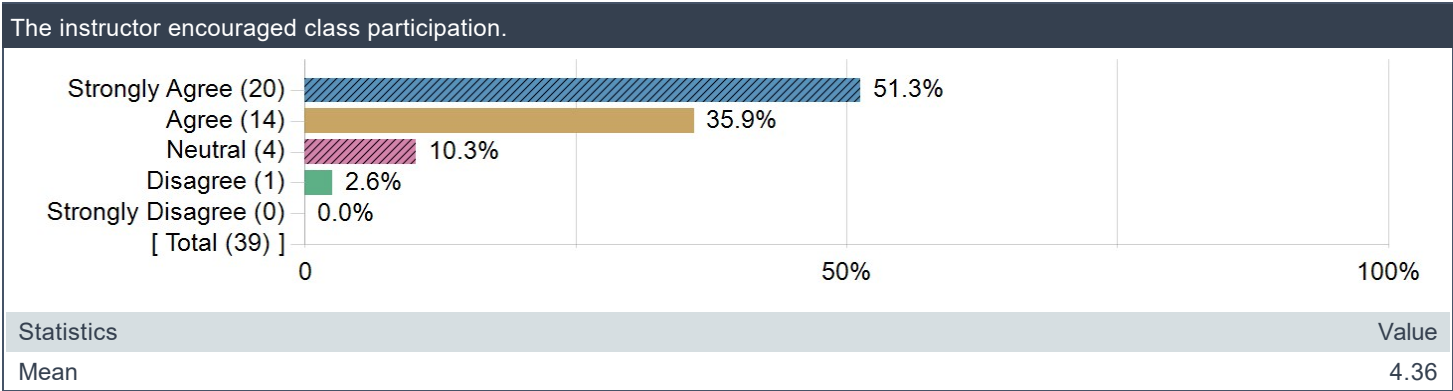
Instructor Questions

	Strongly Agree	Agree	Neutral	Disagree	Strongly Disagree	Responded	Mean
The instructor clearly explained the course objectives and expectations.	45.2%	50.0%	4.8%	0.0%	0.0%	42	4.40
The instructor fostered an inclusive learning environment.	57.1%	38.1%	4.8%	0.0%	0.0%	42	4.52
The instructor effectively explained the concepts and subject matter in this course.	42.9%	47.6%	9.5%	0.0%	0.0%	42	4.33
The instructional techniques kept me engaged in learning.	33.3%	42.9%	16.7%	7.1%	0.0%	42	4.02
The instructor checked for student understanding of the concepts presented in the course.	50.0%	40.5%	9.5%	0.0%	0.0%	42	4.40

Overall Questions



College, School, or Unit Questions



Comment Questions

Identify aspects of the course that were the most effective in helping your learning.

Comments
i liked that he was organized and had good slides
I enjoyed the in class activities that helped us work with partners and the one at the end of class that checked engagement.
Going through the sample R scripts together and the KCs and homework
The biggest aspect of the course was the homeworks.
The in depth lectures
I appreciated how clear the structure of the course was. Real-world examples were provided that aided learning.
The KCs and the HWs were very valuable resources that helped me review and learn the material after class.
– homework – knowledge checks
Working through code examples in class.
Dr. Bolfarine is a great teacher, and he makes the lectures easy to follow. He is a wonderful professor, and the lecture slides and homework reinforced the concepts we learned in class. The Knowledge Checks were also a great and quick way for me to understand if I retained any information during the class.
Going over practice problems together at the end of class.
engaging interactive lectures
The practice exams
I liked his office hours where I could ask questions that I struggled with.
The weekly KCs were helpful in reinforcing the ideas from the week. Because the class was only once a week, these assignments were integral to keeping up with the material.
KCs
The homework + KCs were the most helpful for understanding the material
homeworks
I love that the homeworks and KC are similar to the test.
The detailed slide shows and recorded lectures were very helpful
The HW assignments were immensely helpful in my learning as they provided really good examples and problems for me to apply my in class learning towards.
I really enjoyed how Bolfarine worked with actual datasets and thoroughly explained the relationship or formula that was being used.
Easy assignments
KCs
Knowledge checks and homework after class
Going through the code together in class.
The knowledge checks and practice exams helped me summarize the things I learned in class.
Well structured class timeline
him following along the code with us in class
Doing R in class
having unlimited attempts on the KC and HW I think is great because if you get it wrong, you have to redo it until you understand it.
Engaging lectures, relaxed rules (i.e. no assigned seats), helpful professor

Identify the aspect of the course that you found most challenging, why you found it was challenging, and suggest one thing that could be done to help future students meet that challenge more effectively.

Comments
probably the hardest part was sort of figuring out how to use R studio and he could provide an intro to that
I found it difficult to understand topics in class, as many times one I was lost it was difficult to become unstuck.
The most challenging aspect was the tests. However, they were fairly done with a cheat sheet to help the students.
It being a 2 hour long class, so maybe a couple breaks throughout, but there was a break every other lecture
I think some of the models can blend together, especially when calculating odds and probability. More examples about the differences between models and odds/probability may help.
I feel like the 2 hour class was very long and made it hard to stay engaged. I think it would be better to make it twice a week for an hour each.
– long class hours – difficult to pay attention
Simply because the class was 2 hours, it was sometimes easy to lose focus. I think that the 5 minute break helped me with this.
I found myself getting distracted a little easily, but I think that's due in part to the fact that the class is 2 hours long rather than because of Dr. Bolfarine's teaching.
For some reason, I felt like I understood the material, but I didn't do very well on the exams.
homework were difficult and not much practice before tests
The homework assignments
Some of the homework questions were challenging because they were harder than the in-class practice. Maybe going over the hard homework questions in class can be helpful.
I found it slightly challenging to prepare for the tests because there was so much material to cover as the class only had one midterm and the final. I was often feeling as if some of the concepts were glossed over and then mentioned again on the exam. I think more cumulative questions on the HWs would have been helpful to keep some of the earlier concepts fresh on the mind.
Exams
This class was not particularly challenging.
lots of people used ChatGPT on exam 1. Put the rest of us with integrity at a disadvantage. Would recommend honorlock or better proctoring
I didn't really find much challenging.
The 2-hour class was a little bit of a drag, but the practice of having a 5–10 minute break in the middle is really helpful and I think that should become regular
The most challenging aspect of the course was some of the KC and HW assignments having one or so problems that strayed from the bulk of what we'd learned in class. I think making it so that we go over the homework assignments in class after the due date has passed would be really helpful in making sure that every student understands every HW problem.
I personally think stats is a challenging subject and I feel that its hard to extrapolate what I'm learning to other scenarios or cases. I feel like there should be more questions on homeworks/quizzes about the concept itself and what the interpretations mean rather than coding.
Not very engaging
N/A
2 hour lectures are challenging. taking a break each class would help
Learning how to use R because not being a coder, it is somewhat difficult to use. One thing to help this is giving students more time to code on their own in class to check course concepts.
The content and how long the classes were was very challenging.
N/A
understanding his explanations, he repeats what he says but explains things poorly. I wish he was more clear.
Doing R outside of class
N/A
Class duration (2 hours per lecture) – I would break the class into two 1 hour lectures during the week.